



RELEASE HISTORY

Power Glove Vision Changelog

Versioned features, fixes, security changes, and documentation updates.

2026 EDITION / IAIN BENNETT / MIT LICENSE

- Hardened the V-sign Start command after live Gun Smoke/FCEUmm testing exposed accidental pause pulses. Start now requires a stable 0.65-second hold and a continuous 0.30-second non-V release before it can rearm; movement, A/B, and Select timing are unchanged.
- Confirmed the exact Super Glove Ball ROM's ten-byte native packet, MSB-first reads, `$A0/$5F` detection, `$3F` terminator, native `$82` Start, and continuous X/Y behavior in a deterministic headless trace.
- Corrected the custom Nestopia core to wrap the exact ROM's stream at ten bytes, center zero precisely, and neutralize stale, lost, uncalibrated, and wrong-profile samples instead of retaining a prior coordinate.
- Added reversible per-ROM native Nestopia/FCEUmm selection plus a RetroPie-only isolated core installer; stock Nestopia remains untouched.
- Audited all eight listed US ROMs: only Super Glove Ball consumes native multi-byte glove packets; the other games use standard controller-bit mappings through FCEUmm.
- Added a reproducible matched-savestate direction benchmark. Native Super Glove Ball visibly activates and releases every axis by frame 3, including a 3.1% X step; FCEUmm Gun.Smoke polls input on frame 1 and visibly activates and releases every direction by frame 2.
- Compared the exact Super Glove Ball ROM in both cores, confirmed that FCEUmm remains standard-joypad-only, and corrected native Y wrapping so its packet and screen position span bottom, center, and top.
- Added an optional RetroPie installer offer that builds the pinned GPLv2 native core locally, registers both per-ROM launch choices without changing the saved FCEUmm selection, and installs the upstream license beside the core.
- Made `config/profiles.json` release-owned and replaceable during updates so the shared recognition defaults supersede legacy per-game thresholds; the previous file is backed up and personal calibration and tuning under `data/` remain preserved.

This file records user-visible PowerGlove Vision changes. The project follows [Keep a Changelog](#) categories and uses [Semantic Versioning](#). Git remains the authoritative record for line-level and file-level history.

Two-script installation

- Added versioned UNO Q and RetroPie installers with verified downloads, repeatable updates, backups, and read-only checks.
- Included the early-start and shutdown helpers in UNO Q installation; App Lab's command-line tools install the app and Arduino sketch.
- Added optional emulator installation and registered-game checks, including Bad Street Brawler's game-specific Glove Zap setting.
- Simplified installation instructions and moved manual repair and packaging details into the technical reference.
- Added release packaging and automated installer tests. Fresh-device and physical gameplay validation remain required before a stable release.

Unreleased

- Expanded the third-party runtime inventory for the modified Nestopia core with its patch checksum, affected files, runtime/install boundaries, GPL preservation rules, and pinned-update procedure. Documented stock RetroArch and FCEUmm as externally installed RetroPie dependencies and added an audit check that prevents the Nestopia revision or patch digest from drifting away from the published notices.
- Preserved Nestopia's original source copyright and GPL header verbatim, added a separate file-by-file PowerGlove Vision modification ledger, made the native-core build reject header changes, and installed that ledger beside the optional core and its upstream [COPYING](#) file.
- Made explicit and automatic neutral calibration accept only complete hand observations at 70% confidence or better. Documented its 24-frame averaging, circular wrist mean, 95th-percentile jitter measurement, repeatability limits, atomic replacement, and separation from portable recognition defaults.
- Hardened release validation so installer packages must contain the shared profile baseline and current recognition, tracking, tuning, and native-core selection modules. Update tests now explicitly preserve neutral calibration and personal gesture tuning while replacing release-owned defaults.
- Removed avoidable gameplay diagnostics: finger geometry is measured once, detailed landmarks are prepared only at the 5 fps preview cadence, and idle tuning skips measurement work while unchanged configurations are reused.
- Allowed UNO Q deployments to select an explicit SSH identity and expanded the live deployment gate to verify every published technical guide and PDF.
- Made Menu Guard and the V-sign mutually exclusive with a clear pinky deadband. Menu Guard now has priority, cancels pending Start pulses, and suppresses every ordinary controller button while the safety pose is active.
- Centered gesture, profile, and matrix artwork in Help and printable table columns. Grouped related startup and attention-state matrix photographs into compact visual rows where side-by-side comparison is clearer.
- Made recognition settings global across game mappings, reduced movement travel with [0.28](#) activation and [0.14](#) release baselines, and recorded neutral X/Y jitter so only noisy setups automatically receive higher safe thresholds.
- Expanded Glove Academy from twelve to sixteen mapping-independent lessons with roll left/right, close hand, and a shared menu-guard pose. Practice polls every 75 ms and controller delivery remains paused.
- Added a dedicated menu-guard illustration and substantially enlarged the A/D/H experiment artwork in built-in Help and the gameplay PDF, with balanced text columns.
- Added the isolated [lr-nestopia-powerglove](#) research patch, reproducible pinned build, tracing, and a guarded latest-sample bridge. Only candidate X/Y is wired; exact-ROM validation and promotion remain explicitly gated, with FCEUmm retained.
- Added installation manifests shared by both package installers and Wi-Fi deployment. Updates back up and remove unchanged obsolete application files, preserve local edits, and provide interrupted-update recovery and read-only inventory checks.
- Reduced Start and Select pose debounce to 0.15 seconds, retaining one press per pose and release before repeating.
- Fixed controller session resets, malformed packet rejection, and timeout release during rejected network traffic.
- Applied finger release thresholds consistently in Programs E, F, and G.
- Matched tuning feedback to each recording step and made failed matrix commands retry.

- Preserved existing profile configuration during installation and Wi-Fi updates.
- Unified release/deployment payload selection and installer templates; removed unused helpers and state.

[0.3.0] - Unreleased

Planned feature release: simplified personal tuning, shared gameplay recognition, Bad Street Brawler Glove Zap, and illustrated architecture documentation. Live camera, gameplay, and physical matrix checks remain release requirements.

Added

- Added an optional permanent UNO Q early-start helper after a successful physical cold-boot trial. It releases the installed sketch earlier on each boot while preserving the system boot display and existing hourglass animation.
- Added a Matrix display guide in Help and PDF form, covering every display state, profile letters, pairing sequences, troubleshooting, and photographs of the physical display.
- Added a pulsing startup hourglass before Router Bridge initialization. A dedicated Arduino sketch display task keeps it moving while Linux is starting; ordinary app status then selects the glove, profile, or Academy display. The protected system boot display remains unchanged.
- Renamed the Learn section to Glove Academy in navigation, the page heading, and current guides. Kept [/learn](#) links, lesson/tuning behaviour, and L/T matrix indicators unchanged.
- Added startup stage timings for library imports, model preparation, camera initialization, and first inference.
- Added individual gesture illustrations and Pixel Pal to the website and friendly manuals, with a smaller PNG for web use.
- Preserved and bundled the unmodified Google Hand Landmarker model with Apache 2.0 license text, provenance, and checksum.
- Added offline model-cache installation and recovery from the bundled copy, with verified download fallback only when the bundle is absent.
- Made package builds verify the model and required license files before reporting success.

Changed

- Preloaded OpenCV and MediaPipe in the background when the vision worker starts, keeping controls responsive and the camera off until requested. On the tested cabinet, first activation after a reboot took 1.21 seconds once preloading completed.
- Made [/dashboard](#) the default page, retaining redirects from [/](#) and [/debug](#).
- Made web footers use the release version, with a development indicator on dev builds.

Gesture tuning simplification

- Replaced seven recordings with open hand, gesture, open hand (three seconds each).
- Added optional all-finger hand setup using a gentle fist with the thumb outside.
- Added live extended/curled finger feedback sharing V-sign and thumbs-up recognition checks. Existing saved thresholds remain compatible.

- Live camera validation is required before release.
- Featured common tuning controls and grouped directions, wrist rolls, and other combinations under More adjustments. Added explicit movement-specific starting-position and return instructions for Glove Zap, pull-back, directions, and wrist rolls.
- Added pull-back as the twelfth ordinary Learn lesson, with a live action indicator, backward-distance feedback, and personal pull thresholds.
- Gameplay movement mappings now use shared activation/release states for wrist controls, forward push, pull-back, movement answers, and braking. Preserved game button mappings, pulses, and pull-toggle edges; clear depth activation on tracking loss.
- Matched Tune's T animation to Learn's L using the same scan line, trailing glow, brightness, and frame timing.
- Standardized Glove Zap and Pull Back labels across Learn, Tune, and the guides.

Documentation and firmware reconciliation

- Documented optional five-finger hand setup, three recordings of three seconds, preview/save/discard/reset, extended-only finger handling, and unchanged version-1 saved settings.
- Updated ordinary Learn to twelve lessons with Glove Zap and Pull Back, and documented shared gameplay activation/release states while retaining profile mappings and menu holds.
- Documented matching scanning L/T animations and consistent action names.
- Recorded the verified Zephyr 1.0.0 platform and pinned sketch libraries, distinguishing platform installation, compile-only validation, and firmware upload.
- Refreshed maintained guides and their PDF editions. Historical entries above retain the behaviour and names at the time of each change.
- Retained live camera, game-control, and physical display checks as release validation requirements; automated checks and deployment alone do not satisfy them.

Complete-pose validation before tuning suggestions

- Automatic analysis now requires all selected fingers to match together in at least 90% of accepted samples, including opening and final release phases.
- V-sign validates extended index/middle alongside curled ring/pinky; thumbs-up validates extended thumb alongside four curled fingers, using shared recognition checks and existing personal extension thresholds.
- Failed analysis identifies the finger/phase and clears the preview without modifying saved settings. Existing holds and orientation-flexible thumb extension remain unchanged.
- Added regressions for invalid extended fingers in each phase, personal thresholds, exact boundaries, noise tolerance, simultaneous pose failures, invalid samples, and saved-value preservation. Live camera and gameplay validation remain required.

Bad Street Brawler Glove Zap

- Mapped forward-push activation to a 180 ms simultaneous Left + Right pulse in the Bad Street Brawler profile. Require release before retriggering; cancel on menu poses, tracking loss, and recalibration.
- Enabled opposing directions in Bad Street Brawler's FCEUmm game options while preserving global settings. The existing RetroPie receiver and gamepad mapping need no changes.
- Corrected the earlier documentation claim that this attack required native glove support. Added pulse, cancellation, rearming, and other-profile regressions; all 155 tests passed. A two-frame headless test confirmed the game-specific options load. Live attack validation remains outstanding.

Repeatable RetroPie Glove Zap configuration

- Added `powerglove-bsb-zap` with read-only checks and explicit `--apply` setup.
- Checks installed FCEUmm/RetroArch and game emulator selection; reports missing dependencies or incompatible selection without silently changing either.
- Preserves inherited options and global settings; backs up and atomically updates the game file, with repeat-run detection and rollback instructions.
- Added six isolated tests for creation, preservation, inheritance, missing cores, wrong emulator selection, read-only mode, running games, redirects, and symlinks.
- Documented installation, use, limitations, and the remaining live gameplay check.

[0.2.5] - 2026-09-04

This release adds web game mappings, personal gesture tuning, reliable game-launch profile selection, and refreshed illustrated manuals.

Added

- Added a dedicated T on the UNO Q matrix while gesture tuning is active.
- Added a Games JSON editor with paired RetroPie access, duplicate-name validation, conflict detection, verified saves, backup download, and restoration.
- Added guided Learn tuning with camera measurements, independent gesture thresholds, temporary previews, and persistent personal adjustments shared across profiles.
- Added a confined RetroPie Games service on TCP 55358 and included it in installation and health checks.

Fixed

- Moved game mapping editing into Setup and compacted Learn tuning, placing threshold values beneath the camera.
- Published UDP profile control through a persistent App Lab brick, acknowledged queued requests independently of camera startup, and corrected launch-hook rejection reporting and configuration-error handling.
- Kept profile changes responsive during blocked camera startup or reads, and reused the camera and tracker when switching between active profiles.

- Added exact compressed ROM filenames to the default registry so supported `.zip` and `.7z` games can select their profiles.

Documentation

- Refreshed all six interface screenshots on September 4, 2026, blurring camera imagery before capture.
- Illustrated Setup's Games section and Learn's compact Tune layout across the guides, including the T matrix indicator.
- Regenerated the printable manuals to match the updated Markdown and screenshots.
- Reorganized the overview and installation guide around a complete, numbered setup path: Git download, App Lab package import, UNO Q host setup, RetroPie installation, pairing, and gameplay checks.
- Added Programs A-I controls to the overview and a complete command-line reference with project flags, defaults, arguments, and the system-command options used in the guides.
- Applied reader-focused writing conventions across the guides, added first-round game exercises, and corrected the RetroPie update path. PDF regeneration remains a separate publication step.
- Reviewed all Markdown guides for natural English, replacing sentence fragments and compressed notes with complete explanations while retaining concise tables and release entries.
- Revised the Quick Reference with complete installation prerequisites, camera inspection commands, embedded screenshots, calibration explanations, and step-by-step game registration. Clarified shutdown readiness and local tests.
- Corrected stale lesson counts, profile descriptions, calibration behaviour, pairing guidance, reboot verification status, and receiver removal steps.
- Proofread the Quick Reference and normalized Markdown list indentation and continuation text for consistent rendering.
- Regenerated all ten PDF editions, repaired internal section links, and improved heading and image pagination.

[0.2.0] - 2026-09-03

Added

- Added an app-owned Avahi resolver brick that survives App Lab Compose regeneration, replacing the temporary direct socket mount.
- Added one-command host setup for RetroPie and UNO Q, with managed-file backups, preserved private configuration, delayed startup, and read-only PASS/FAIL/ACTION checks. Empty pairing tokens no longer cause restart loops.
- Added explicit A, B, and GLOVE ZAP practice lessons and live indicators. Learn consistently uses the general profile without changing the selected game.
- Added a Glove Master completion achievement to Learn after all eleven lessons are recognized, with Start again and Dashboard actions. Skips do not count.
- Added hand illustrations to every Learn lesson and finger/pose feedback for Start and Select. Learn accepts confirmed menu poses after their short button pulse ends, rather than requiring a second hold longer than the pulse.

- Added a live active-profile selector to the Dashboard without changing the startup profile saved on Setup.
- Added temporary Learn sessions that start vision while preserving the selected profile and desired controller state, including multi-tab leases and automatic recovery when a page disappears unexpectedly.
- Added a dedicated matrix gestures-idle state with a pinball-style animated glove, separate from both true shutdown and the flashing error X.
- Added a dedicated Learn-mode matrix state with a bright L and moving grayscale scan highlight.
- Added a root-owned tmpfiles rule that restores shutdown-helper readiness after reboot or App Lab application replacement.

Changed

- Shutdown now requests a graceful system halt instead of poweroff, which was observed to reboot the UNO Q. Reinstall the host helper to apply this change; hardware tests subsequently confirmed automatic restart with both the powered hub and direct Mac USB connection. Remaining halted is a known unresolved limitation.
- New installations leave the RetroPie destination blank, show generic hostname examples, and keep local practice available before pairing. Controller start requires a destination; saved destinations survive updates.
- Added persistent host Avahi resolution for .local gameplay and pairing destinations, with five-second address refresh and deployment mount setup.
- Standardized Dashboard/Learn Calibrate actions with red busy and blue completed feedback, consistent navigation buttons, and shorter Connection/Shutdown labels.
- Prioritized controller transmission before matrix updates and limited browser JPEG encoding to 15 fps; added inference_ms and send_ms diagnostics.
- Prepared SSH pairing dependencies separately in the persistent runtime cache so dependency downloads do not consume the SSH connection deadline.
- Tuned thumbs-up/Select closed-finger detection to 0.42 using live pose measurements, retaining the straight-thumb requirement and deliberate hold.
- Tuned V/Start closed ring and pinky detection to 0.42 using live pose measurements, retaining straight index/middle checks and the deliberate hold.
- Tuned curl activation/release to 0.50/0.35 using live comfortable index-curl measurements. Learn now follows the same hysteresis state as gameplay, independent of pulsed buttons. Calibration resets held finger switches.
- Finger curl now uses the strongest joint bend and includes the base knuckle for the four fingers. Learn exposes exact curls, a magnified landmark view, and forward-movement readings. Push lessons use continuous feedback so a one-frame event cannot be missed by browser polling.
- Camera finger curl now uses 3D world landmarks, with an aspect-corrected normalized-depth fallback. Movement and gesture thresholds are unchanged.
- Made Dashboard and Learn show camera/tracker startup with elapsed time and a first-start explanation, without enabling the camera in Gestures off.
- Kept Learn startup feedback updating before camera frames arrive and disabled centring until vision is active.
- Replaced generic Program A-I labels on Dashboard and Setup with the program letter and its intended game or use, while retaining the existing profile IDs.

- Standardized the reader-facing game name "Gun Smoke" throughout Help and the public guides; exact [Gun . Smoke](#) ROM basenames remain unchanged for matching.
- Made leaving Learn restore the selected profile, camera state, and controller state. Loading or refreshing the Dashboard now clears abandoned Learn sessions, prevents their old heartbeats from reactivating vision, and reapplies the selected mode.
- Made Wi-Fi deployments preserve PowerGlove Vision as the UNO Q default startup app so the dashboard returns after a board reboot.
- Made Wi-Fi deployments restore the shutdown readiness marker when the installed host watcher is active.
- Extended deployment health verification to tolerate a three-minute cold App Lab runtime startup.
- Made deployment verification use the UNO Q address from the active SSH connection instead of accidentally selecting a Docker bridge interface.
- Made **Gestures off** a healthy worker state that releases controller input, closes the camera and MediaPipe tracker, and keeps the website and authenticated RetroPie profile listener available.
- Made camera and model initialization lazy so idle mode performs no capture or vision processing and can return to an active profile without restarting the website.
- Reworked the matrix attract sequence into distinct pinball-style beats: a four-frame energy sweep, a broad travelling cuff, a staged glove reveal, intermediate finger curls, an eight-position spark with a comet trail, one outline pulse, and a readable hold.
- Used the UNO Q matrix's full eight-level grayscale range to separate the dim glove body, spark halo, bright spark, and whole-glove pulse.

Documentation

- Documented the UNO Q matrix as an eight-level monochrome DMD/BitPixel-style design target, including silhouette, contrast, motion, pulse, and physical review guidance for future animations.
- Standardized source headers with each file's purpose, author, copyright, SPDX license identifier, local history, and links to the complete history.
- Documented public interfaces and non-obvious security, lifecycle, tracking, packaging, and rendering functions.
- Added this centralized project changelog and its print-ready PDF edition.
- Added an automated audit for required source headers, module descriptions, and production Python interface docstrings.
- Added a complete configuration reference covering JSON templates and active copies, gesture thresholds, manifests, RetroArch mapping, systemd units, generated state, secret handling, and the App Lab installation ZIP location.
- Added GitHub Actions checks for supported Python versions, tests, source and documentation audits, syntax, PDF builds, and App Lab installation ZIP verification.
- Added a security policy for private reporting, pairing and network boundaries, shared-token handling, shutdown permissions, and dependency integrity.
- Added a contributing guide for code style, tests, documentation, changelog, generated artifacts, commits, and pull requests.
- Added reusable documentation and App Lab installation package verification tools.

- Added an illustrated, one-page-per-game handbook for all eight automatically configured titles, with original direction, finger-pose, wrist, and depth art.
- Placed cropped gesture illustrations beside the corresponding instructions in the gameplay handbook, including the universal V-sign and thumbs-up controls.
- Added the same contextual gesture illustrations to every Program A-I card and documented the menu gestures shared by all nine programs.
- Added an off-script gameplay section that encourages safe experiments with other NES and Famicom games, especially the unassigned A, D, and H programs.
- Updated the cabinet cheat sheet with off-script profile testing, safe behaviour for unknown games, and exact ROM registration guidance.
- Renamed the built-in installation Help route, retained the original URL as an alias, and aligned its summaries with the Play Checklist terminology.
- Extended the documentation audit to require Help-library coverage and a gameplay section for every title in the shipped game registry.
- Expanded Wi-Fi deployment verification to confirm the current installation and gameplay guides, raw Markdown, and gesture artwork on the UNO Q.
- Fixed the Help renderer so the allowlisted gesture images embedded in control tables appear alongside their actions, while unsafe raw HTML remains escaped.
- Extended UNO Q deployment checks across every Help guide and representative gameplay and Programs A-I illustrations.
- Documented the required Markdown-to-PDF workflow and UNO Q Help synchronization steps for documentation contributions.
- Added offline PDF links to every public Help guide and the project overview, while keeping the cabinet-specific quick-reference PDF private.
- Included the nine allowlisted public PDFs in UNO Q deployments and App Lab installation packages, with package and live-route verification.
- Established [dev](#) as the integration branch, documented release and hotfix promotion into [main](#), and enabled CI validation for pushes to both branches.
- Refreshed the Dashboard, Learn, and Setup screenshots from the running UNO Q after the tagline, compact diagnostics, and safe-shutdown controls were added.
- Added an offline Help library that renders the maintained public Markdown guides with responsive navigation, contents links, illustrations, tables, code samples, and access to the original source.
- Added a dynamic **This cabinet** Help page whose UNO Q links follow the browser's validated hostname or IP and whose non-secret RetroPie values come from the active configuration.
- Rewrote the configuration reference for public installations, with guided UNO Q and RetroPie setup, field-level behaviour, safe gesture tuning, network boundaries, backup and recovery advice, and symptom-based troubleshooting.
- Renamed the Field Guide as the Installation Guide and generalized camera instructions for UVC-compatible USB cameras while recording the Razer Kiyo as tested reference hardware.

Fixed

- Changed Wi-Fi deployment to use SFTP staging and terminal-backed remote commands for UNO Q systems that stall non-terminal SSH sessions.
- Allowed the UNO Q deployment health check to use the board's current IP when its `.local` name pauses during a container restart.
- Published the host shutdown request atomically so a filesystem observer cannot consume the request between file creation and the final content write.
- Updated the GitHub Actions workflow to use the current Node 24 action releases and run the Python 3.7 compatibility job on Ubuntu 22.04.
- Corrected Program I so index curl accelerates in Knight Rider, a forward push accelerates with turbo, and thumb curl fires the weapons.

0.1.0 - 2026-09-03

Added

- Camera-only Power Glove tracking on Arduino UNO Q with MediaPipe.
- Gesture profiles for Bad Street Brawler, Super Glove Ball, and cartridge-free Programs A-I.
- Authenticated UDP profile selection and virtual Linux gamepad output for RetroPie, including per-game runcommand hooks.
- Dashboard, live diagnostics, offline gesture lessons, configuration controls, camera recovery, controller start/stop controls, and UNO Q matrix feedback.
- Wi-Fi deployment, App Lab packaging, runtime-asset retrieval, branded PDF generation, and a fixed-purpose host shutdown helper.
- Project overview, installation guide, quick reference, profile handbook, third-party component notice, screenshots, and reproducible build instructions.

Changed

- Delayed RetroPie receiver startup until EmulationStation finishes its initial device scan, preventing the virtual controller from disrupting cabinet input.
- Made the controller start disarmed and kept tracking/dashboard operation alive when RetroPie or the camera temporarily becomes unavailable.
- Moved private device settings and downloaded model data outside the App Lab installation ZIP.
- Changed the App Lab installation ZIP to download Google's Hand Landmarker model on first launch and verify its pinned SHA-256 digest before installation.

Fixed

- Recovered cleanly from USB camera disconnects and slow UVC camera wake-up.
- Kept the vision loop responsive through receiver, DNS, Wi-Fi, and mDNS loss.
- Corrected password pairing so credentials never appear in command arguments and the shared token is transferred and installed reliably.
- Corrected UNO Q dependency isolation, secure token upload, PDF builder file mode, landscape diagnostics layout, and cabinet launch integration.

Security

- Added short-lived TLS pairing with certificate comparison, a physical single-use PIN, bounded handshakes, and restricted token-file permissions.
- Required confirmation and a fixed host-side request path for system shutdown.
- Added a third-party component notice covering licenses, provenance, pinned versions, checksums, and update procedure.

Neutral calibration retention

The app now saves completed calibration so the reference survives transitions between Learn and gameplay, profile changes, camera reconnections, and restarts. When you recalibrate, the app replaces the saved reference atomically.

RetroPie mDNS installation

The RetroPie setup command now installs [avahi-daemon](#) and [libnss-mdns](#), enables Avahi at boot, and checks both the service and dependency. Existing hostname configuration and pairing settings are preserved. Fresh-machine installation has not yet been tested.

The UNO Q installer also installs and checks [libnss-mdns](#) alongside Avahi for host-level resolution, while retaining the separate app-container resolver.

Documentation and shutdown wording consistency

The documentation now explains when to recalibrate, which files to back up, and what the hand-identification score means. Shutdown confirmations also explain that the UNO Q may restart automatically.